INV-010 · The Nvidia Spy Scandal

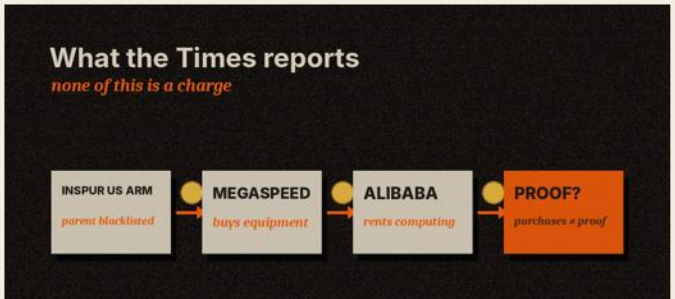
Storyboard v1 · ledger look (same kit as INV-007 to INV-009)

- Script v1: 85 paragraphs · 2356 words · about 18 min of voice, ~19-20 min cut
- Mix by narration time: graphics 63% · video 14% · photos 23% (target 50 / 30 / 20)
- Every video clip and photo matches the line being spoken. If no match is found, the shot becomes a graphic.
- No 'Illustration' label on screen (YouTube's synthetic-content box is still ticked at upload).
- Photos and clips in this storyboard are first picks from Pixabay; final clips are fetched per line before render.
- Then every paragraph in order, with a grade label under each photo or clip.















The most valuable chip company on Earth has just admitted its CEO had an affair. American intelligence officials believe the woman was working for China.

GRAPHIC **CO-01**

Recreated staff-memo page (no logo), 'I was unfaithful' highlighted + red pen circle; REPORTED stamp



This is the Nvidia spy scandal. And at one point on Monday the ninth of November, it had wiped nearly four hundred billion dollars off the company.

VIDEO **CO-02** COLOUR · INTENSE

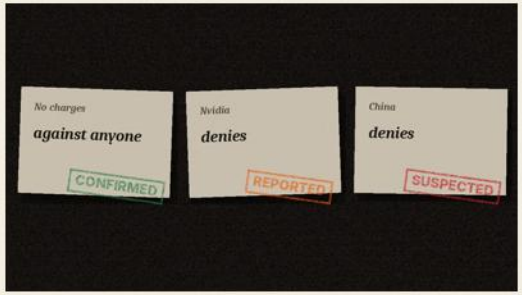
Trading screen with red falling numbers, no faces + label 'NVIDIA SPY SCANDAL · ≈ -$400BN'



If you have a pension or a 401(k) in an index fund, some of that was yours. About seven cents of every dollar in an S&P 500 fund sits in this one company. On an average 401(k), that's around ten thousand dollars.

GRAPHIC **CO-03**

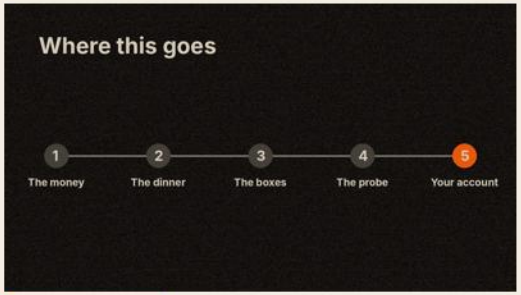
Coin graphic: a dollar splits, 7 cents lit; ≈ $10,000 of an average 401(k)



Nobody has been charged with anything. Nvidia says no secrets were lost. China calls it a smear.
We'll show you what's confirmed, what's reported, and what's only suspected.

GRAPHIC **CO-04**

Typed cards stamped CONFIRMED · REPORTED · SUSPECTED



By the end, you'll see the whole bill. We'll count the money, sit at one dinner in Taipei, open some boxes in Malaysia, follow an investigation that stopped, and come back to your account.

GRAPHIC **CO-05**

Roadmap: five stops light in a row



Part one. The four hundred billion dollar morning.

GRAPHIC **P1-01**

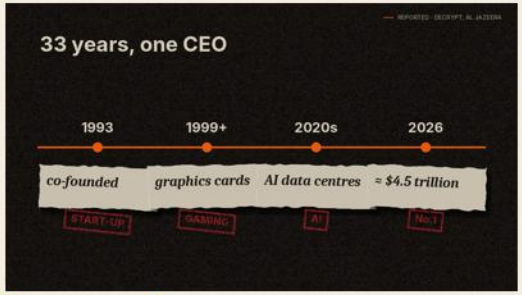
Part card 01 'The $400 Billion Morning'



Sunday, the eighth of November 2026. Jensen Huang, the man who co-founded Nvidia in 1993 and has run it ever since, sends a memo to his staff. He says he was unfaithful to his wife.

PHOTO **P1-02** COLOUR · CALM

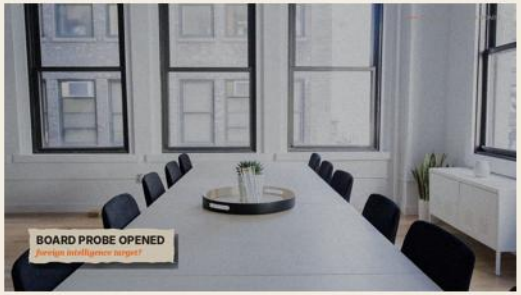
Glass tech-company headquarters exterior, no logo, slow push + label 'SUN 8 NOV 2026'



In thirty-three years, he took Nvidia from a graphics-card start-up to the company whose chips nearly every AI system on Earth is trained on. He's one of the most recognisable business leaders in the world, and he's never been accused of a crime.

GRAPHIC **P1-02b**

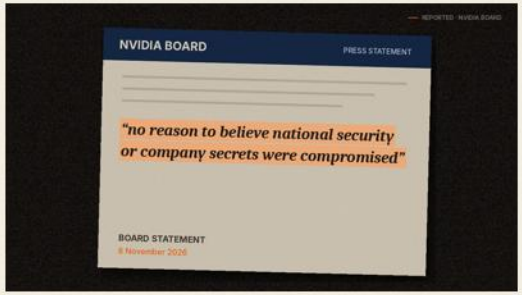
Timeline 1993 → 2026: founded, gaming cards, AI data centres



The same day, Nvidia's board opens an independent investigation. Not into the affair. Into whether its CEO was the target of a foreign intelligence operation.

PHOTO **P1-03** COLOUR · CALM

Empty boardroom table in daylight, no people + label 'BOARD PROBE OPENED'



The board says it has no reason to believe national security or company secrets were compromised. It says it still has confidence in him.

GRAPHIC **P1-04**

Letter card: board statement 'no reason to believe'



Monday morning, the market opens. The S&P 500 goes up. Nvidia goes down. At its worst, about nine percent. Close to four hundred billion dollars of value, gone at one point in a few hours.

VIDEO **P1-05** COLOUR · INTENSE

Stock exchange ticker board, numbers moving + label 'S&P 500 UP · NVDA DOWN 8.8% AT THE LOW'



To put that in size. Four hundred billion dollars is more than the whole yearly economy of most countries on Earth. It vanished on a memo about a marriage.

VIDEO **P1-06** SHADOW

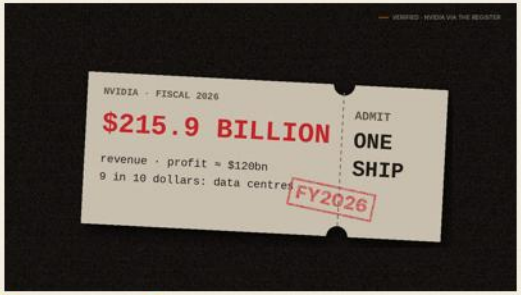
Falling red stock chart on a monitor + label '≈ $400BN IN HOURS'



And it came on top of a bad month. From early October to early November, Nvidia had already lost about one point three trillion dollars of value, in a wider sell-off of AI stocks.

GRAPHIC **P1-07**

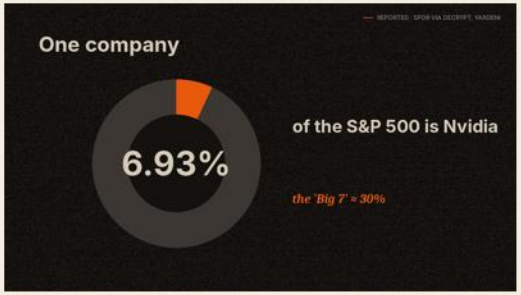
Odometer: $5.78T rolls down to $4.51T (6 Oct → 6 Nov)



That's a company that took in about two hundred and sixteen billion dollars of revenue in its last full year, and kept about a hundred and twenty billion of it as profit. More than nine in every ten dollars came from data centres, the warehouses where AI is trained.

GRAPHIC **P1-07b**

Ticket: FY2026 revenue $215.9bn · profit ≈ $120bn



Why does any of this touch you? Because Nvidia isn't just a company. It's about seven percent of the S&P 500, the index most pensions and 401(k)s follow.

GRAPHIC **P1-08**

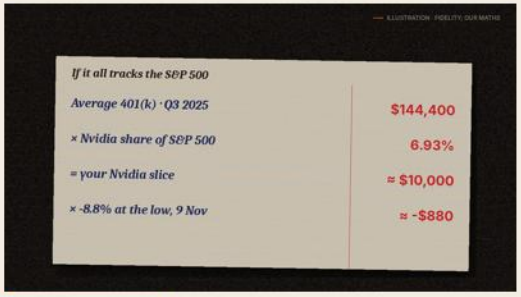
Donut: Nvidia 6.93% of the S&P 500; Big 7 ≈ 30%



More than half of American households have a 401(k). And most of them sit in target-date funds that buy companies by size. The bigger Nvidia gets, the more of your money goes into it, automatically.

PHOTO **P1-09** COLOUR · CALM

Row of suburban houses, daylight, no people + label '54% OF US HOUSEHOLDS HAVE A 401(k)'



Fidelity says the average 401(k) holds about a hundred and forty-four thousand dollars. If all of that tracked the S&P 500, about ten thousand would be Nvidia. At the worst point of that Monday, that slice was down about eight hundred and eighty dollars.

GRAPHIC **P1-10**

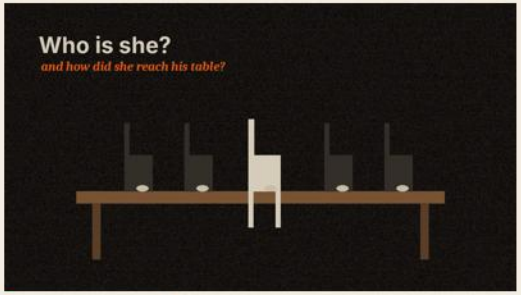
Division: $144,400 → $10,000 slice → -$880 at the low



In Britain and across the world it's the same story. Global index funds hold Nvidia as their single biggest company. You don't have to buy one share to own a piece of this scandal.

PHOTO **P1-11** COLOUR · CALM

City of London financial district skyline + label 'NVIDIA ≈ 5% OF THE GLOBAL INDEX'



So who is the woman at the centre of all this? And how did she end up at the CEO's table?

GRAPHIC **P1-12**

Year/number card: an empty chair at a set table (cut-paper)



If you want to see every line of a bill like this before it lands in your account, subscribe. Next, we follow it from the boardroom to your pension statement.

GRAPHIC **BR-01**

Envelope: next invoice tile (INV-009 Taiwan 2027) + SUBSCRIBE



Part two. The dinner in Taipei.

GRAPHIC **P2-01**

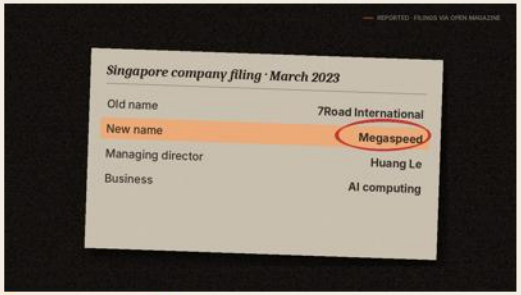
Part card 02 'The Dinner in Taipei'



Her name is Alice Huang, also known as Huang Le. She's a Chinese citizen. She is not related to Jensen Huang. They only share a surname.

GRAPHIC **P2-02**

Manifest-style dossier card: HUANG LE ('ALICE') · CHINESE CITIZEN · NOT RELATED (no photo)



In March 2023, a Singapore company called 7Road International changed its name to Megaspeed. Filings show she became a managing director. Megaspeed builds the computing power that AI runs on.

GRAPHIC **P2-03**

Document: Singapore filing card '7ROAD → MEGASPEED · MAR 2023' highlighted



In June 2024, she was photographed beside Jensen Huang at a tech gathering in Taipei. Every year, the chip world flies there for a trade show called Computex.

VIDEO **P2-04** COLOUR · CALM

Taipei skyline with Taipei 101 at dusk, slow pan + label 'TAIPEI · JUNE 2024'



On the twenty-second of May 2025, during Computex, he hosted a dinner in Taipei. Reports say she was there too.

GRAPHIC **P2-05**

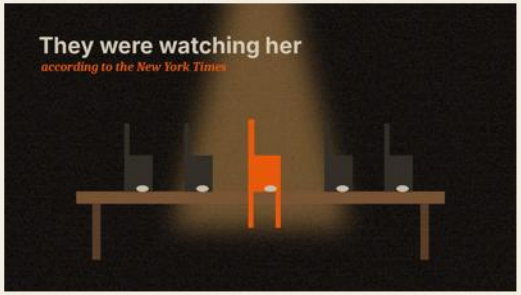
Calendar: 22 MAY 2025 · DINNER · TAIPEI (Computex)



For a chip boss, that's an ordinary night. Customers, suppliers and partners all want a seat at his table. Nvidia says meetings like that are not unusual, and Megaspeed was a customer.

VIDEO **P2-05b** COLOUR · CALM

Long restaurant table with candles and glasses, no faces + label 'NOT UNUSUAL'



But US officials weren't watching him. According to the Times, they were watching her. And surveillance of her showed a close relationship with Nvidia's CEO.

GRAPHIC **P2-05c**

Spotlight graphic: one chair lit at a dark table



Then, on the twenty-ninth of October 2026, the New York Times published what US officials had concluded. That she was a Chinese intelligence asset, passing information back to Beijing.

PHOTO **P2-06** COLOUR · CALM

Folded newspapers on a table, no readable mastheads + label 'NYT · OCT 29, 2026'



The Times and the Financial Times reported that China's Ministry of State Security had recruited her, to gather information on Jensen Huang, and possibly to steer Nvidia's chip sales to China.

GRAPHIC **P2-07**

Map: red thread Beijing → Taipei → Santa Clara, 'MSS?' tag



What did she learn? Nobody outside the intelligence services knows. The report says it's unclear what she passed on, or what it was worth. And her whereabouts are unknown.

GRAPHIC **P2-08**

Checklist: three UNKNOWNs (what she learned, what it was worth, where she is)



Singapore says it never investigated her. But its police confirm they are investigating Megaspeed. China's foreign ministry calls the whole story an unsubstantiated smear.

VIDEO **P2-09** COLOUR · CALM

Singapore skyline at dusk, Marina Bay + label 'SINGAPORE · CHINA RESPOND'



Now, this isn't the first time a story like this has been told. History has a name for it.

GRAPHIC **P2-10**

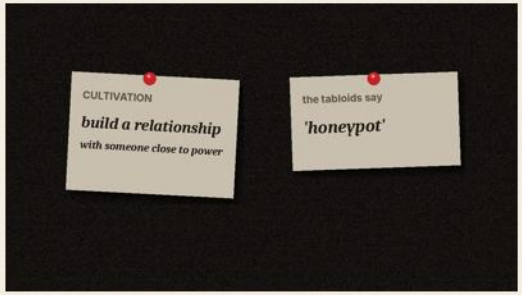
Lights-out beat: dark ledger, single line 'History has a name for it'



Part three. The oldest trick in the file.

GRAPHIC **P3-01**

Part card 03 'The Oldest Trick'



Spy agencies call it cultivation. You build a relationship with someone close to power, and you wait. Sometimes it's a friendship. Sometimes it's more. The tabloids call it a honeypot.

GRAPHIC **P3-02**

Folder: index cards CULTIVATION / 'honeypot' in pencil



In December 2020, Axios reported that a suspected Chinese operative called Christine Fang had spent years building ties with American local politicians, including helping raise money for a congressman. He was never accused of wrongdoing.

GRAPHIC **P3-03**

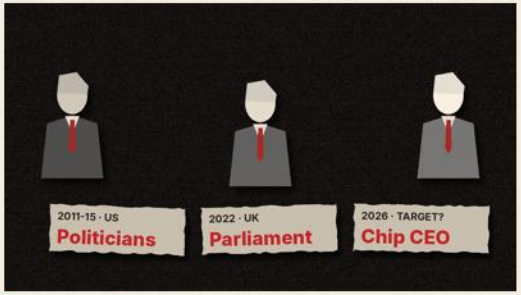
Clipping: recreated Axios headline Dec 2020, 'not accused' highlighted



In January 2022, Britain's MI5 took the rare step of warning Parliament about a London lawyer, Christine Lee. It said she was acting for a Chinese Communist Party influence department.

PHOTO **P3-04** SHADOW

Palace of Westminster at night, no faces (shadow) + label 'MI5 ALERT · JAN 2022'



Those were politicians. This time, officials believe the target was a businessman. But not just any businessman. The man who decides who gets the chips that power artificial intelligence.

GRAPHIC **P3-05**

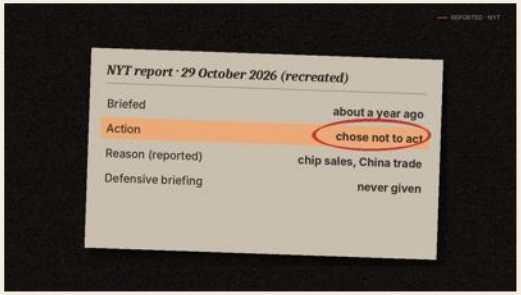
Figures: POLITICIAN · POLITICIAN · CHIP CEO, third lit orange



And here's what makes it different from every case before it. American officials told the President about this a year ago.

PHOTO **P3-06** COLOUR · CALM

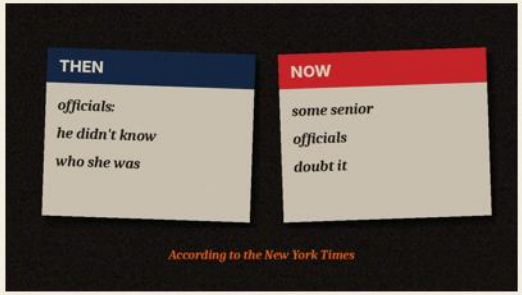
White House exterior, slow push + label 'OCT 2025 · BRIEFED'



According to the Times, the President chose not to act, reportedly wary of disrupting chip sales and trade with China. Jensen Huang himself was never given the formal warning officials call a defensive briefing.

GRAPHIC **P3-07**

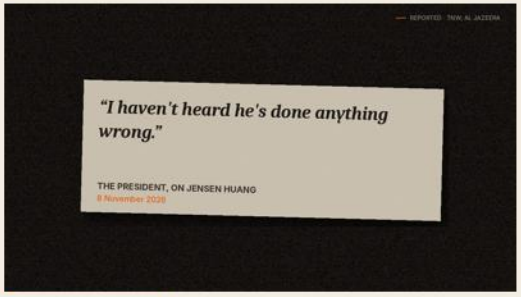
Document: recreated NYT paragraph 'chose not to act' circled



When the President was first told, officials reportedly didn't believe Jensen Huang knew who she was. The Times says some senior officials now doubt that. Nvidia's board says it has seen nothing to suggest secrets were lost.

GRAPHIC **P3-07b**

Halves: THEN 'he didn't know' / NOW 'some doubt it'



On the eighth of November, the President defended him. He called him an honourable guy, said he hadn't heard he'd done anything wrong, and said he'd still take him on his trip to China.

GRAPHIC **P3-08**

Quote card: 'I haven't heard he's done anything wrong' · Nov 8 2026



So why would a spy service care about one company's sales? To answer that, you have to open some boxes.

PHOTO **P3-09** SHADOW

Stacked wooden shipping crates in dim light + label 'OPEN THE BOXES'



Part four. The boxes in Malaysia.

GRAPHIC **P4-01**

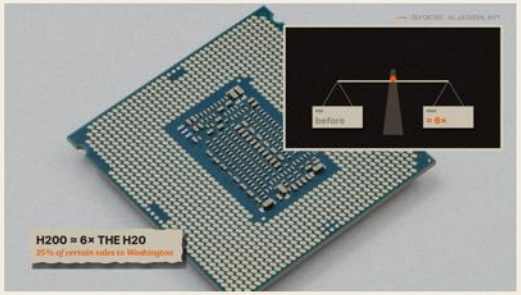
Part card 04 'The Boxes in Malaysia'



Nvidia's best chips are the engines of the AI race. America bans its very top chips, the Blackwell line, from being sold to China.

VIDEO **P4-02** COLOUR · INTENSE

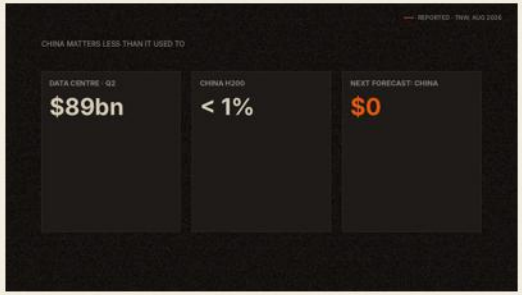
Server racks with blinking lights in a data centre, slow dolly + label 'BLACKWELL: BANNED FOR CHINA'



In December 2025, the President allowed sales of an older chip, the H200, about six times more powerful than the one China could buy before. Washington takes a twenty-five percent cut of certain sales.

PHOTO **P4-03** COLOUR

Computer chip / GPU macro, no logo + label 'H200 ≈ 6× H20 · 25% CUT'



China matters to Nvidia, but less than it used to. In the summer of 2026, its first H200s shipped to China, and they made up less than one percent of eighty-nine billion dollars of data-centre sales. Nvidia's next forecast assumed no Chinese data-centre money at all.

GRAPHIC **P4-03b**

Tiles: data centre $89bn · China H200 < 1% · next forecast: China $0



So every top chip that reaches China by the back door is worth a fortune. And that's where Megaspeed comes in.

GRAPHIC **P4-04**

Navy map: Singapore + Malaysia glow, dotted line north to China



In late 2024, an American official visited a data centre in Malaysia and saw Nvidia equipment still sitting in its boxes. That visit started a Commerce Department investigation.

VIDEO **P4-05** SHADOW

Warehouse aisle of sealed cardboard boxes, low light (shadow) + label 'MALAYSIA · LATE 2024'



Trade records show a Megaspeed sister company in Malaysia bought at least four point eight billion dollars of AI equipment with Nvidia chips inside, between June 2024 and February 2026.

VIDEO **P4-06** COLOUR

Container port with cranes, Southeast Asia + label '≥ $4.8BN · JUN 2024 - FEB 2026'



That's purchases, not proof that anything was smuggled. But the Times reports Megaspeed rents computing power to Chinese firms, mainly Alibaba, and buys some equipment through the American arm of a Chinese server maker whose parent is blacklisted.

GRAPHIC **P4-07**

Flow: Inspur US arm → Megaspeed → rented to Alibaba (dotted); PURCHASES ≠ PROOF



Megaspeed denies smuggling. Nvidia says it's like any regional customer, that earlier smuggling claims were checked and debunked, and that it follows the law. Nvidia still lists Megaspeed as a cloud partner.

PHOTO **P4-08** SHADOW

Data-centre corridor, cold light, no people + label 'BOTH DENY'



Here's the half-receipt so far. Nearly four hundred billion off the company in a morning. About ten thousand dollars of an average 401(k) riding on it. And almost five billion dollars of chips in the question.

GRAPHIC **P4-09**

Half-receipt: ≈$400bn · ≈$10k · ≈$4.8bn



And then the investigation into those boxes stopped.

PHOTO **P4-10** SHADOW

A closed file folder on a dark desk (shadow) + label 'AND THEN IT STOPPED'



Part five. The probe that stopped.

GRAPHIC **P5-01**

Part card 05 'The Probe That Stopped'



For months, agents at the Bureau of Industry and Security, the part of the Commerce Department that polices chip exports, worked the Megaspeed case.

PHOTO **P5-02** COLOUR · CALM

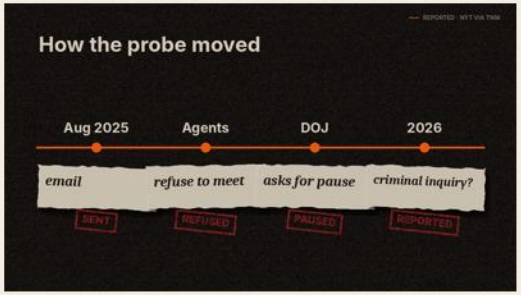
Rows of filing cabinets / archive folders + label 'COMMERCE · BIS · MEGASPEED FILE'



In August 2025, according to the Times, Nvidia's top lawyer emailed those agents. He said a senior Commerce official had approved him reaching out.

VIDEO **P5-03** COLOUR · CALM

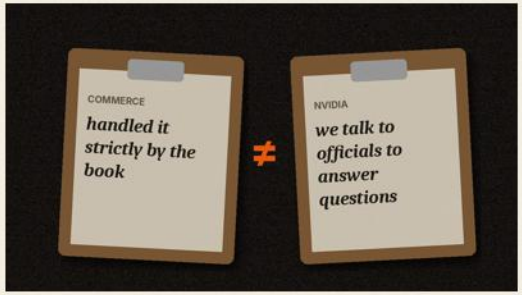
Hands typing on a laptop keyboard, close, no face + label 'AUG 2025 · THE EMAIL'



The agents refused to meet. They sent the emails up the chain. Later, the Justice Department asked Commerce to pause its work, and Commerce did. The case is reported to be a criminal inquiry now.

GRAPHIC **P5-04**

Timeline: email → refused → DOJ: pause → criminal inquiry?



Commerce says it handled everything strictly by the book. Nvidia says it talks to officials to answer questions and share what it sees in the field.

GRAPHIC **P5-05**

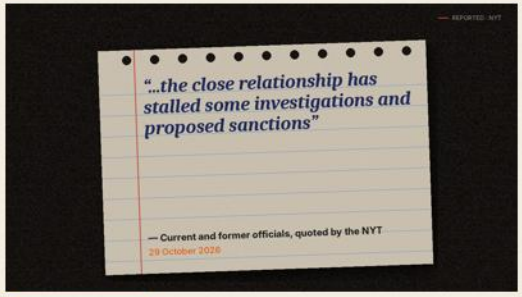
Versus: COMMERCE 'by the book' / NVIDIA 'we answer questions'



One more number. Other agencies proposed putting Megaspeed on the government's blacklist of companies. It hasn't happened. In fact, Commerce hasn't added a single company to that list in over a year.

GRAPHIC **P5-06**

Number: entity-list additions, last 12 months: 0



Officials quoted by the Times say the close relationship between the President and Jensen Huang has stalled some investigations and proposed sanctions at Commerce. The White House declined to comment on the report.

GRAPHIC **P5-06b**

Notebook: 'stalled some investigations' (NYT, officials)



Now it's in the open. On the ninth of November, shareholders filed a proposed class action, saying Nvidia and its CEO hid his ties to a suspected spy.

PHOTO **P5-07** COLOUR · CALM

Courthouse columns, daylight + label 'SHAREHOLDER SUIT · NOV 9'



In Congress, three House committee chairs want a closed-door briefing on the eighteenth of November. Senator Elizabeth Warren is demanding answers and tighter export laws.

PHOTO **P5-08** COLOUR · CALM

US Capitol dome, daylight, slow push + label 'CONGRESS · NOV 18'



And the day before that, Nvidia reports its quarterly results. Two dates, back to back, that will move the money in your fund.

GRAPHIC **P5-09**

Calendar: 17 NOV RESULTS · 18 NOV CONGRESS



So what happens to your account from here?

PHOTO **P5-10** COLOUR · CALM

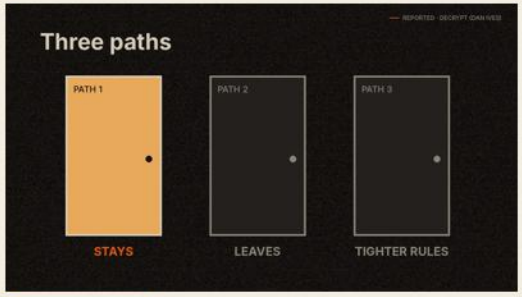
Paper statement and calculator on a kitchen table + label 'YOUR ACCOUNT'



Part six. What happens next.

GRAPHIC **P6-01**

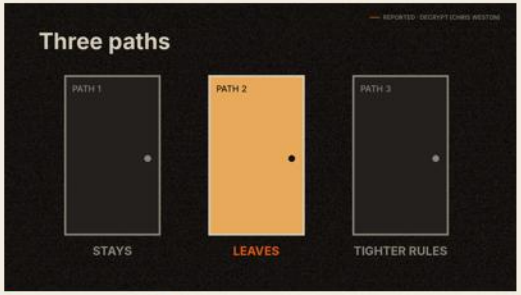
Part card 06 'What Happens Next'



Path one. The review clears him, and he stays. That's what the board and the President both say they want. Analysts say Nvidia has no obvious successor. One called him not replaceable.

GRAPHIC **P6-02**

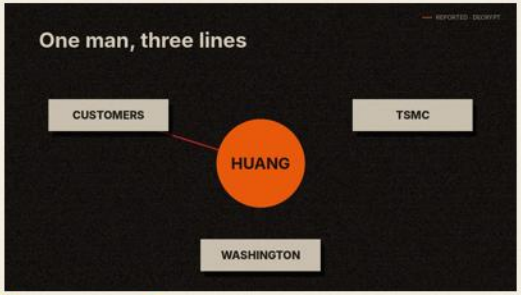
Roadmap of three doors: door 1 STAYS lit



Path two. He leaves. Jensen Huang is sixty-three and has run the company for more than thirty years. One market strategist said a departure could mean an absolute bloodbath for the shares.

GRAPHIC **P6-03**

Door 2 LEAVES, stock line behind drops (bars)



Why would one man matter so much? Because he holds the biggest customer relationships, the supplier deals in Taiwan, and the phone line to Washington. Analysts say he built the company around himself.

GRAPHIC **P6-03b**

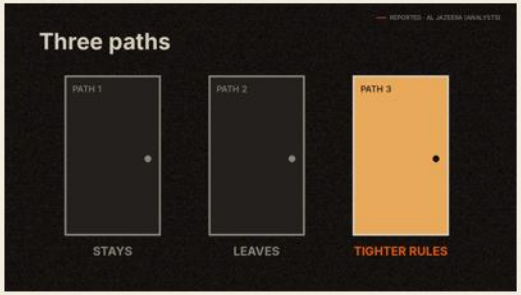
Flow hub: HUANG → customers · TSMC · Washington



Nobody can tell you which path. These are scenarios, not forecasts. But the more of your fund sits in one company, the more one man's private life becomes your business.

GRAPHIC **P6-04**

Typed card SCENARIOS, NOT FORECASTS



Path three is the slow one. Washington tightens the rules on who can buy these chips, and where they end up. Every extra check adds cost and delay. And the AI companies who pay for the chips pass those costs on.

GRAPHIC **P6-05**

Door 3 TIGHTER RULES: toll gate across a chip conveyor (pricetags)



You can already see where that ends. Nvidia has told its customers server prices will rise by more than fifteen percent from early 2027. Those servers run the chatbots, the cloud storage and the apps many of us now pay for every month.

VIDEO **P6-05b** COLOUR · CALM

Hand scrolling a phone on a kitchen table, no brand, no face + label 'SERVERS +15% · EARLY 2027'



That rise was announced before any of this scandal. Tighter rules would only add to it. It's a small line on your bill, but it arrives every month.

GRAPHIC **P6-05c**

Number: +15% … and rising?



And here's the part no model prices. If officials are right, a foreign service got close to the man who decides where the world's most wanted chips go. And the people told about it a year ago chose to wait.

PHOTO **P6-06** SHADOW

Empty boardroom at night, city lights through glass (shadow) + label 'THE PART NO MODEL PRICES'



And let's be honest about what nobody knows. What, if anything, she learned. Whether he knew who she was. Whether any chips really reached China. And whether anyone will ever be charged.

GRAPHIC **P6-07**

Checklist: four things nobody knows, stamped UNKNOWN



So, line by line, what does it come to in your account?

GRAPHIC **P6-08**

Receipt printer warms up (empty receipt)



The Receipt. The Nvidia spy scandal, for an example saver with an average 401(k). These are illustrations, not forecasts.

GRAPHIC **RC-01**

Receipt header: THE RECEIPT · THE NVIDIA SPY SCANDAL



Line one. Your Nvidia slice. About seven cents of every dollar in an S&P 500 fund. On an average 401(k), about ten thousand dollars.

PHOTO **RC-02** COLOUR · CALM

Coins in a glass jar, still + receipt line 1 inset



Line two. One bad morning. At the low on the ninth of November, about eight hundred and eighty dollars off that slice.

GRAPHIC **RC-03**

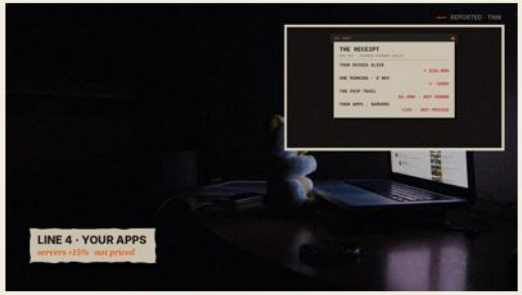
Receipt: line 2 ONE MORNING ≈ -$880



Line three. The chip trail. Four point eight billion dollars of equipment under question. Your cost: not known yet.

GRAPHIC **RC-04**

Receipt: line 3 THE CHIP TRAIL · $4.8BN · NOT KNOWN



Line four. Your subscriptions. Nvidia's servers rise more than fifteen percent from early 2027. How much reaches your phone bill or your cloud plan: not priced yet.

PHOTO **RC-04b** COLOUR · CALM

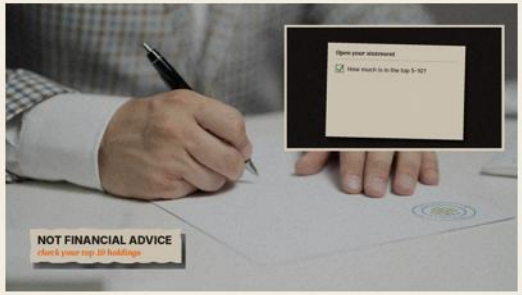
Laptop with cloud/app screen on a desk, no brand + receipt line 4 inset



Line five. The dates to watch. The seventeenth of November, results. The eighteenth of November, Congress.

GRAPHIC **RC-05**

Receipt: line 5 WATCH 17 NOV · 18 NOV



What can you do? This is not financial advice. But a few things make sense in any market. Open your pension statement and see how much sits in the biggest five or ten companies. You might be surprised.

PHOTO **RC-06** COLOUR · CALM

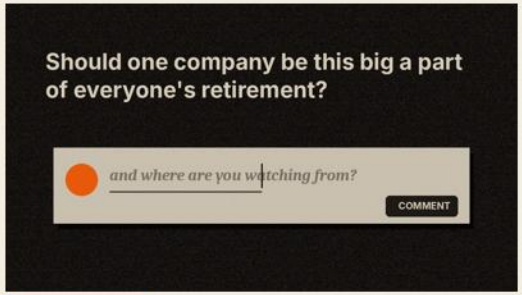
Documents and a pen on a desk (pension statement) + check-your-top-10 card



If you're close to retirement, ask your provider what your fund does when one giant falls. And don't trade on headlines. A memo can move a market in a morning, and a board statement can move it back.

GRAPHIC **RC-07**

Steps: ask your provider · don't trade headlines



Tell us in the comments. Should one company be this big a part of everyone's retirement? And where are you watching from?

GRAPHIC **RC-08**

Comment card: SHOULD ONE COMPANY BE THIS BIG?



Somewhere, a woman whose whereabouts are unknown may hold the answer. Until then, the bill is already in your account. Every crisis sends a bill. History keeps the receipts.

PHOTO **RC-09** SHADOW

Empty chair at a dinner table, dim (shadow); fade to the plain end card